User Documentation Assignment

Write a set of instructions/a user guide for a ***specific software application*** using the principles from in class work and on Learning Hub about instructions and writing for the web. You are writing a "How-to" guide. For example, say you want to show people how to use Learning Hub. One part could be"How to upload an assignment to Learning Hub."

The assignment is to be completed in pairs.

Your guide must contain separate sections as follows:

- Introduction
- 4 sets (pages) of detailed instructions
- Glossary
- Troubleshooting guide
- An updated readme.md file for the shared repository

In the **Introduction** section, explain the software's function and intended use, identify the specific tasks the user will be performing, briefly identify your intended readers, add conventions, and add admonitions that will be used throughout.

The **sets of instructions** should include *separate tasks* in the software, each requiring a single set of instructions.

The tasks chosen should be *sufficiently complex* to require instructions of the length specified. **Each set** of instructions ***must include***

- A main heading
- A brief overview
- Subheadings as needed
- Graphics with captions, alt-text, and mouse over information
- Separate blocks of instruction steps
- Notes, cautions, and warnings as needed (admonitions)
- A conclusion

In the **Glossary** section, you should define some key terms *from the instructions* that may be beneficial to the intended reader.

The **Troubleshooting Guide** should contain a minimum of 5 things that could potentially go wrong with your instructions, and the solutions to these issues.

The **readme.md** should indicate to a reader who accesses your GitHub - an employer, for example - what the instructions are about, including the methods and processes you used to get to the final product. As we will be covering both instructions and reading on the web, and .....

best practices for both, this kind of info can show the reader your understanding of key concepts, use of markdown, and use of other software to get to the final product. It is, in effect, a document that sells your skills in process and product.

Assignments will be evaluated according to how well you have applied the principles of instruction writing and writing for the web to your work.

If you rewrite an existing manual or section of a manual, *substantial changes* must be made. You must also hand in a copy of the original text with your assignment so that the changes you have made can be evaluated. Failure to submit the original text can result in a charge of plagiarism and a mark of 0 for this assignment.

You must have your pages ready to be tested in labs. Two groups of your peers will test your instructions out and provide feedback to help before submission.

Due date for testing your docs: April 9th, in labs

Do not write instructions for simplistic tasks like installing software using a wizard. There's no point in writing instructions if no instructions are required to complete the task.

Your task is to write an *instruction* manual or user guide. Do not submit a *reference* manual listing resources and/or strategies for successfully completing a game of some kind. Reference manuals will not be accepted.

Please add me as a collaborator to your repository, so I can assess you work.

User Documentation Grading Rubric (25%)

Initial Criteria 1: User must be able to complete instructions. Final grade will be affected if user cannot.

	Clear	Mostly clear	Vague	Unclear	Missing

Introduction (3%)

- Explains software's intended use
- States what specific instructions are for
- Identifies intended user & knowledge level
- Shows typographical conventions used
- Shows admonitions used

Instruction Pages (10%)

- Lists every step required to complete task
- *Each* action has own numbered step
- Uses command verbs to begin steps
- Steps are separated from information
- Provides admonitions (notes, warnings) clearly and in correct place
- Includes graphics clearly with alt-text and titles
- Contains introduction and conclusion for each page

Glossary (1%)

- Provides appropriate definitions for user level
- Provides meaningful and concise definitions

Troubleshooting Guide (2%)

- Lists likely problems & provides appropriate solutions/actions

Readme.md (1%)

- Contains all relevant information for employer to understand documentation

Content and Organization (8%)

- Uses content appropriate for intended user
- Images are located where expected
- Headings/subheadings parallel, clear, and structured
- Each instruction is clear first time
- Instructions are concise and chunked effectively
- All content is available for user to complete tasks

Final Criteria: Documentation must be thoroughly edited and proofread. Final grade impacted if errors affect readability (≤ 20%). See next page for further information.

0% Deduction: Outstanding
Grades in this range describe work that is perfect or nearly perfect. A piece of this quality will surpass basic professional standards in all categories. All writing is clear, correct, and concise. The English language, grammar, and punctuation will be almost flawless. Few if any changes will be necessary before the work could be delivered to a professional audience.

5% Deduction: Excellent
Grades in this range describe work that is generally of the outstanding quality described above, but further minor editing and proofreading will be needed before the work could be delivered to a professional audience. The piece of work might need minor revisions or corrections to improve clarity, conciseness, or correctness.

5-7.5% Deduction: Well done
At the higher end of the range, there will be no serious problems with clarity, conciseness, correctness. A few of these areas will need definite revision, but none will be completely unacceptable. At the lower end of the range, several areas will need revision before the work could be delivered to a professional audience.

10-15% Deduction: Adequate
Grades in this range describe work that is acceptable or barely acceptable. Work in this category is often considered “average,”. There should be no need for major revisions in format, clarity, conciseness, and correctness, but either minor revisions will be needed in almost all areas or a few areas will show repeated or significant flaws.

20% Deduction: Unacceptable
Work in this category has failed to meet professional standards. It might need major revisions in clarity, conciseness, and correctness. If basic standards are not met in even one of these categories, the work is unacceptable. Work which contains repeated or significant errors in language, grammar, or punctuation is not ready to pass.